

The Crossroads



01

Le Mans Disaster
by Yashwarrdhan Kejiriwal

 108
CHINMAYA
JAYANTI

#YouthTalksWithGurudev
Letters depicting conversations
between Gurudev and the youth

CHYK CIRS

Through His Lens
Sri. BG Sripal
Editorial Team

Influence Of Words
*Aryan India
Gavaskar*

April - May 2024 | Issue 16



CONTENTS

River of Wrath - A poem by Avika Rahul Mundra of Grade 10 featured in this month's issue.

Papyrus - A poem on a most common article for study - paper - by Anirudh P of Grade 7 featured in this month's issue.

The Editorial - Get Your Daily D.O.S.E.
The Crossroads Editorial Team

#CIRSCaptures - Shaurya Agarwal of Grade 12
MGMT as Narada in the Holi Cultural Program
Photo by SS Shailesh | Grade 12 SCI



03

#YouthTalksWithGurudev
Letters depicting conversations
between Gurudev and the youth

CHYK CIRS

01
Le Mans Disaster
Yashwardhan K.

02
FANDOM
Mridul Motwani

04
Fear
Nandini Khemka

05
Beat the Heat!
Rishi Suresh Iyer

06
How Pollution Affects the Oceans
Ramkrishna Ajay Kulkarni

07
God is Just a Call Away!
Br. Sanatan Chaitanya

08
Through His Lens - Sri. BG Sripal
The Editorial Team

09
The Influence of Words
Aryan IG

10
CIRS - A Happening Place!
The Editorial Team

11
Gaia's Spell - a Bihar Story
Aashi Kedia

12
Nature's Embrace: An Ode to the Mother
Malini Khemlani - GirlUp Mahattva

13
ABC of the Stock Market
Naitik Agarwala - Youth Economic Initiative

EDITORIAL

GET YOUR DAILY D.O.S.E.

How many of us are really happy? Take a minute to think about it. Are we truly happy? How many times a day do you battle with a lack of motivation, procrastination, loneliness, stress or anxiety? If your number happens to be higher than a 3; then you, my friend, are severely lacking your daily dose of D.O.S.E. Let me introduce you to the big four who help supplement your emotions and keep you carefree and content.

The first happy hormone - meet Dopamine! Tough and driven, with a gleaming, ready smile. It is he who stimulates motivation, learning and joy, giving you the determination to achieve your goals. The "I did it" feeling is something all of us deeply yearn for, that sudden rush of accomplishment that paints a blissful smile on our faces. Dopamine keeps you on your toes, pressing against your boundaries and pushing beyond your limits. However, too much of this guy gets you into deep waters. Dopamine is inexhaustibly addictive; it gives you instant gratification, but leaves you craving for more. Tip a little too much into his side, you'll be scrambling with addiction. Nevertheless, you **NEED** dopamine. When you feel down, blast your favorite music or move your languorous limbs; don't let yourself fall into the miserable crevice of melancholy. Match his smile! Trust me, you'll feel so much better.

Oxytocin, she's the glue holding together the fragile webs of relationships. Also celebrated as the "love hormone" and the "cuddle chemical", this soft matronly being is all things sugar and warmth. Oxytocin creates the emotion of trust and comfort, letting your body bond better with those who you call family and friends. She strengthens your interactions with other people, relieves stress and is a constant fosterer of sunshine, rainbows and positive emotions. Embrace her profusely!

How confident and powerful do you feel after you were applauded by people? The subtly higher tilt of the head, the slow grin easing into your face...

Yeah that, that's good old Serotonin working his hand. Chin in the sky, smug smile, mane of buttermilk hair and a personality louder than the speakers the politicians use; ladies and gentlemen, I give you Serotonin. From finding opportunities to being assertive, Serotonin rewards you with instant happiness, a rather placid form of confidence. Serotonin is a booster of confidence; he gives you the power to lead and take charge. Channel him more often, and let him guide your actions.

You won't realize her presence in a room; Endorphin is unbothered and nonchalant. With her plum-dyed curls, piercings, the works and the ability to soothe, she is the release of brief euphoria that masks pain. A triggering factor when experiencing runner's high, Endorphin is at her all-time high when you exceed your limits. Considered a natural type of painkiller, she has the capacity to ease pain and mask the perceptions of pain, a distraction of sorts. Silent yet striking, she knows how to get her way and I think that's a lesson all of us can learn from her.

The way a plant needs sunshine to grow and a fish needs water to thrive, your brain needs nourishing too. A quotidian necessity, all 4 of the hormones are vital to have a stress-free and happy brain. When your brain is happy, you'll be able to focus on all your tasks and perform proficiently. Think of it this way. Imagine a library with all its contents in disorder, books shelved wrong, creased and dog-eared. If you're anything of a reader, you will be deeply disturbed. That will be the very state of your mind without daily bouts of these happy hormones. Every hand you attempt will yield far more satisfactory results when your brain is focused and unflustered.



*The big four
help supplement
your emotions
and keep you
carefree and
content!*

- Manassa V. | IB II Year, CIRS

01



“

“The scene on the other side of the road was indescribable. The dead and dying were everywhere; the cries of pain, anguish, and despair screamed catastrophe. I stood as if in a dream, too horrified to even think.” - Duncan Hamilton (Jaguar driver)

What we know as one of the most prestigious events in motorsports, the pinnacle of endurance racing in today's world and the pride of Le Mans to host it every year in the Circuit de la Sarthe, is the 24 hours of Le Mans. This 24-hour race that demands a lot of concentration, energy and commitment has a dark spot of blood etched in its history.

The 1955 Le Mans disaster, otherwise termed as the most tragic incident in the history of motorsport, ended up taking around 80 innocent lives of spectators and injuring 120 people. This bloody incident has been recounted as one of the darkest days in motorsport history. The 1955 Le Mans started off with a spectacular lineup consisting of drivers of high caliber like Stirling Moss, Fangio and Castellotti. What made this Le Mans so competitive is the fact that it pitted all three manufacturers - Jaguar, Mercedes and Ferrari - against each other at the peak of their powers. Ferrari was the reigning champion, Mercedes had its new ultra-light, magnesium alloy body and Jaguar was ready to throw all it had at the competition.

Le Mans Disaster

Yashwarrdhan Kejiriwal | IB I Year, CIRS

The start of the race was exciting, with Jaguar and Mercedes swapping new lap records with each passing lap. Ferrari started to fall behind and on the 35th lap disaster struck. The Jaguar driven by Mike Hawthorn was going for a pit stop for refueling. Mike put his hand up signaling Austin Healey driver, Lance Macklin, to let him go. Macklin moved up to let the Hawthorn go to the pits. This led to Macklin losing control of the car and his brakes operating unevenly. Due to all this commotion, he did not notice the Mercedes coming behind him at the speed of 240 km/hr. This caused the car to collide with the Austin Healey. The rear acted as a ramp, resulting in the Mercedes driven by Pierre Levegh to go airborne into the stands. The car flew overhead for 80 meters and rolled over. The driver, Pierre Levegh, fell out and crushed his skull on impact, causing him to die instantly.

The car landed on the earthen embankment between the spectators and the track, bounced and slammed into a concrete stairwell structure and disintegrated. The momentum of the heaviest components of the car - the engine, the tires and the front suspension - ended up killing several in the crowd, crushing almost all in their path. The bonnet lid scythed through the air, chopping up heads of spectators like a guillotine. When the car finally landed in the stands, the fuel tank exploded into flames and the magnesium body of the Mercedes resulted in the spread of white hot flames across the stands and track. These white hot flames greatly intensified as water was added to them because they were magnesium ember flames, resulting in the car burning for hours.

Whereby, the Austin Healey car completely lost control and crashed into the pit walls, fortunately causing no casualties. Even the driver, Lance Macklin, survived.

Even though Levegh's car killed several spectators, in the last few seconds before he went airborne he raised his hand, so he could warn oncoming driver Juan Manuel Fangio. Fangio later said that the singular reason he survived the debris and the commotion was Levegh's warning.

Jaguar driver Duncan Hamilton, watching from the pit wall, recalled, "The scene on the other side of the road was indescribable. The dead and dying were everywhere; the cries of pain, anguish, and despair screamed catastrophe. I stood as if in a dream, too horrified to even think."

The most shocking fact is that even though this catastrophic event occurred, the race never stopped. On later inquiry, it was said that if officials would have stopped the race, there would be jamming of roads with all the viewers trying to leave, impeding the medical and emergency crews in rescuing the injured. The race ended with Jaguar emerging victorious as both Mercedes and Ferrari retired, leaving them with no competition. The incident was so grave that it resulted in a temporary ban of motorsport in France, Spain, Switzerland and West Germany.

A lot of drivers retired from motorsport after this incident including Macklin, Fitch and Mike Hawthorn. This incident acted as a reminder for the inclusion of various safety measures in motorsport. To this day, it shows that motorsport is one of the toughest and most dangerous sports in the world. As Juan Manuel Fangio once said, "To finish first, you must first finish."





FANDOM

Issue 16

Mridul Motwani | IB I Year, CIRS

02

Fandoms transcend the borders of social differences, accepting new layers of interpretations...



Centuries ago, the streets of Olympia were filled with roaring crowds of fans arriving from faraway places to witness the ancient Olympic games. The same culture is seen in stadiums today, with thousands of viewers cheering tirelessly for their teams. Fandoms have been a part of history for longer than we have been aware, and presently their impact is felt more prominently than ever. In this fast-paced world of diversified lifestyles and constant change, fandoms are vivacious phenomena, born out of shared enthusiasm among people surrounding literally anything. Be it the revolutionary world of Pokémon, which brings awe to the imaginations of countless kids, or the infamous IPL - the mega-event that keeps fans on the edge of their seats till the very last ball, evoking new emotions at every turn of the game. Such fields of interest possess immense fanbases, creating platforms for an exchange of perspectives. Fandoms transcend the borders of social differences, accepting new layers of interpretations that enrich the tapestry of fan culture.

These fandoms serve as a haven for artistic expression. Countless hours and tremendous talent is invested in making fan art and fan fictions. All this, while seemingly pointless, is the outcome of the endless inspiration fans can draw from their interests.

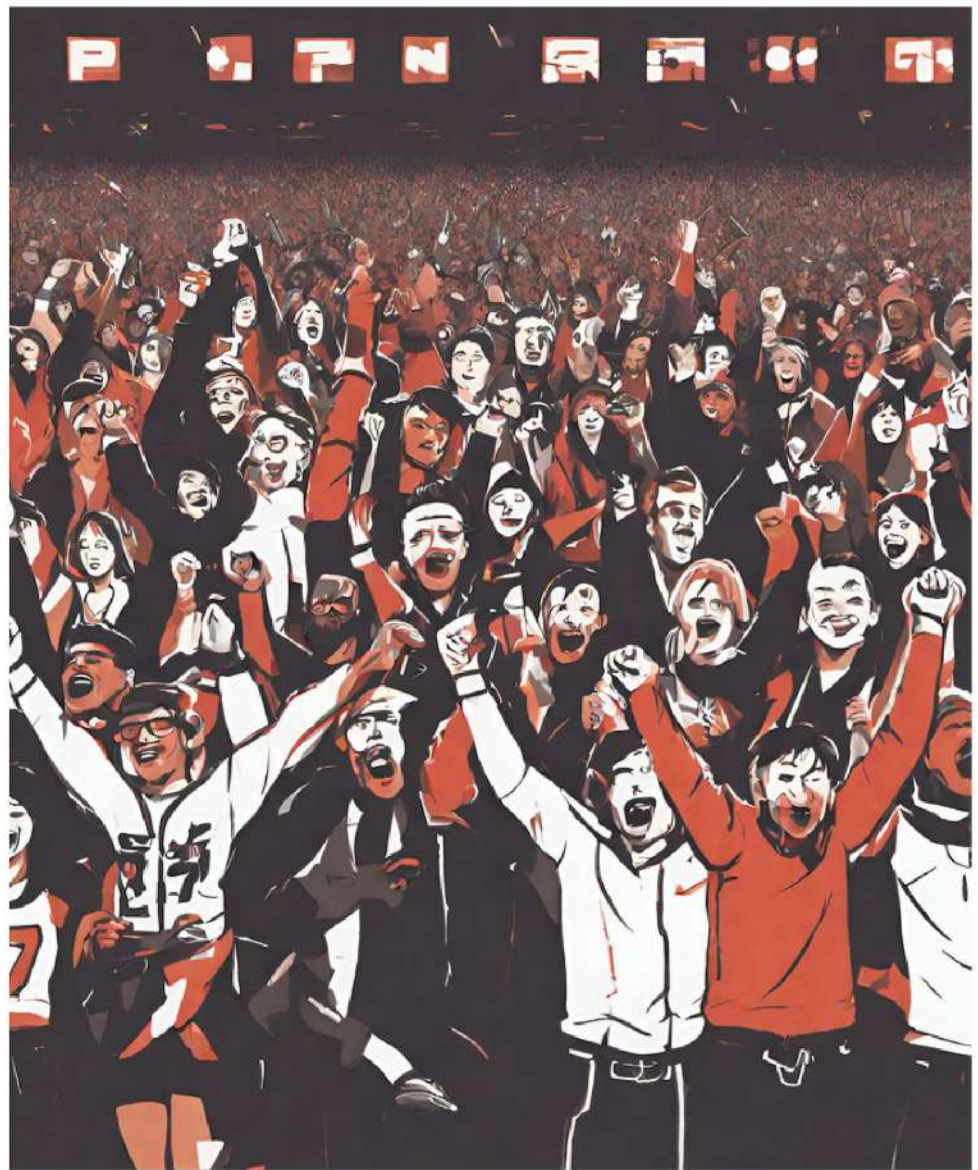
Marvel, for instance, is known for creating characters that reflect the lives of the fans; flawed and imperfect heroes that are driven by purpose. Why is Spiderman the most popular comic book character? The way his persona has developed over the years shows how even while facing disheartening life struggles, Peter Parker refrains from giving up on his heroic purpose. I personally feel that such depths of character in Marvel characters inspire tiny, but remarkable improvements in me.

Despite having 16 years of unfulfilled hope, RCB fans still show up every single year with the same firm faith. What creates such a connection between a franchise and the fanbase? Little things that the team does, like calling its fanbase the '12th Man Army', or simply the positive vibrant fervour RCB media has instilled in its fanbase, bring them together every matchday.

This iconic team never fails to captivate the fans with the unpredictable thrill of the sport. It becomes a part of the fan's identity, feeling the pride of being an RCB fan.

These examples are nothing. The scale of implications that fandoms have on society is often ignored. Imagine primary school years without Harry Potter discussions, or to not have sports teams to cheer for. Think what it would be like to not have a means to escape reality and enter worlds of fiction, to not have people to relate your interests with. It would be a dull world, lacking creativity. For me and countless other people, fandoms create a common ground to initiate conversations, which makes socialising much easier and more interactive.

Just like how the highly acclaimed Shakespearean plays became a topic of widespread debate and discussion in the Renaissance Age; we now have numerous fictional universes that have millions of fans pondering alternate stories. The rise of media like Netflix and anime along with sports like Formula 1 are drawing more and more people towards their fandoms. This, whilst providing quality entertainment, also has tremendous economic impact. In 2021, Disney earned \$56.2 billion from merchandise sales alone.



Fan culture ranges very distinctively, from pseudoscientific flat earthers to the BTS army. In this plethora of subjects, everyone can find an interest they are passionate about. So, start exploring now. You never know where you may find the perfect fandom for yourself.

RIVER OF WRATH

**Roaring and ravaging down ragged peaks,
Seeking slaughter, it shatters and shrieks.
A crescendoing cacophony of chaotic crimson,
Vicious with vengeance towards the victorious ones.**

**Dripping with desire, laced with lust,
Breaking bonds & tampering with trust.
Fueled by fury, it flows and flows,
Gulping up the greats as it goes.**

**Harnessing hatred & drowning dreams,
Perhaps it's weaving the world, stitching its seams.**

**Maybe it's restoring righteousness in every realm,
Guiding its ship, guarding the helm.**

**Yet its iridescent intentions are known by none,
For any soul its touch has led to run.
But know its source is closer than it appears,
For it rages from your own fears.**

Avika Mundra | Grade 10, CIRS



Guidance to young Bharati Sukhatankar, who is serving the Chinmaya Mission through the years in various capacities.

Miss Bharathi,

Life is a field. The more we cultivate it, the more is our profit. We have the freedom to be an idle farmer or an industrious one. If one is idle, weeds shall grow; if active, we shall gather a rich harvest.

Majority leave their wonderful extent fallow, and allow weeds. They therefore harbor poisonous crawlers among the luxurious weeds. If at all, they cultivate but the near courtyard of their life. The wide expanse, up to the boundaries, where the horizon dips, lie waiting for the plough-man and his life-giving touch of intelligent tenderness.

Now you choose. You are Bharathi. Look around? What is wrong with Bharat itself? Should you Bharathi then doubt? Hesitate? Jump at it. Finish the training. Whether you are going to be a teacher or not, the very training is a beautiful discipline. It cannot but give you a knowledge of some of the weaknesses inherent in our present educational system.

Carry the “torch”, wherever you go. Lovingly persuade your friends and students to think of the higher values. In your friendship, let them gather the spirit of divine enthusiasm to seek, to strive and to reach the Essential Peace – the true joy of living. If teachers have culture and religion, children cannot be otherwise. Give my love to your mother and Damayanthi.

Swami Chinmayananda.

Gurudev wrote to young Siddhartha Reddy, who was unwell, not only to alleviate his immediate pain, but also to prepare him for adult life.

Your sweet letter. Life in this world is always like this — some pain will be with us all always. Even if we have no physical pains, and all people love us, then we mentally create sorrows for ourselves. It has to be so.

Prayer is the only steady, joyous state. Surrender to Him all your pains. Be a hero and in spite of pains you SMILE!! You will soon get well – Jai Jai Jagadeeswara. Be regular in your japa. Do it lovingly, sincerely.

Love Love Love,

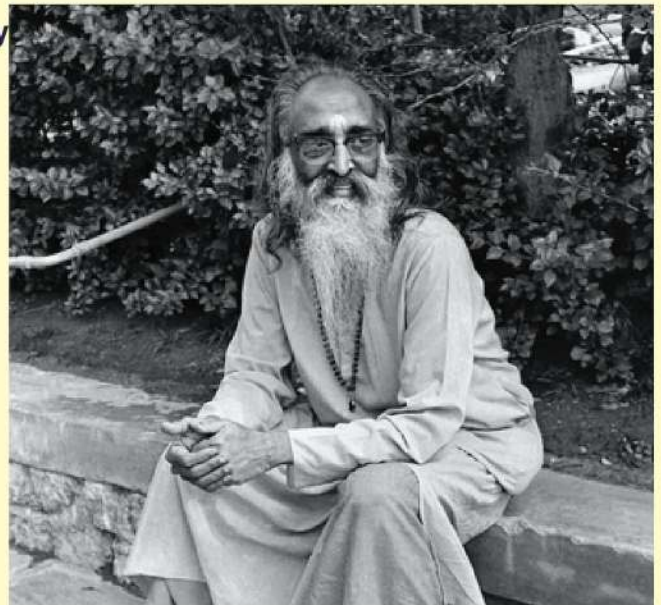
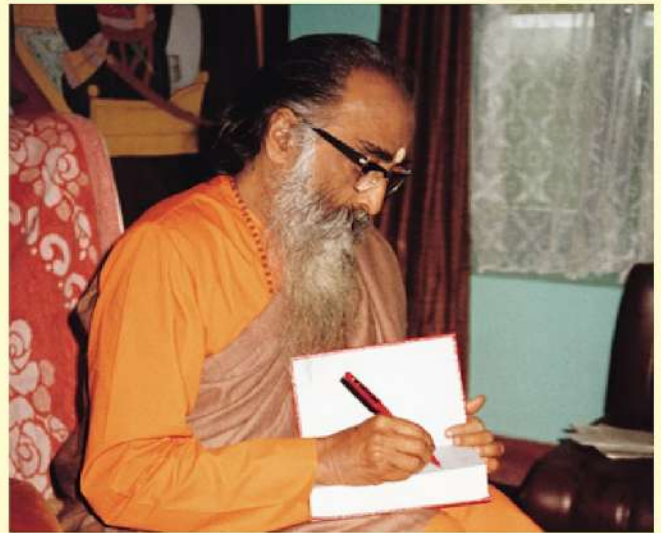
Swami Chinmayananda.

Gurudev teaches a young man who was training in military service how to face new situations and come to terms with the realities of life.

Children generally refuse to eat a thing which they didn't like because of the “form” or “colour”. However, when forced, they come to “love” it and later on crave for it. We also as soon as we meet a new challenge, consider it unconducive, dangerous, dirty and even abominable. But once you settle down to it, the very same situation appears comfortable, interesting and enjoyable. Be ever ready to “face” all situations. Learn to meet all challenges and yet keep your inner balance. This is easy to one who is a devotee, who can see everything as arranged by Him.

Signed,

Swami Chinmayananda.



04

Fear



Nandini Khemka | Grade 12 MGMT, CIRS

False Evidence Appearing Real. FEAR! What a word, right? The word alone is enough to send shivers down our spine and blanket our minds in fog. It is the one common feeling in all of us, naturally making it the most basic emotion. But, is it present from the time of our birth? No! Obviously not. Fear is a perception created by our own minds of all the possible pain. Naturally as infants we wouldn't even know the 'P' of pain. It is only when one starts understanding pain, they come across the chilling emotion of fear.

For example, a tiny tot, who is always fascinated by fire, would always have a wish to touch it, although this desire dies the second the flames have been touched and the little child experiences the burning sensation for the first time. This feeling, later on may become what we call **fear**! This first experience of pain, is what forms the base for everyone's fear which haunts them till their last breath, until treated the right way.

From childhood, our mind has been enslaved to **fear FEAR itself**. We have been forced to set a mindset that fear is a terrible thing and it only holds one back from doing what is necessary, when it is necessary. However, fear isn't all that negative! Fear, in fact, is a tool that equips us with the survival instincts required by each one of us to respond to the vicious situations prevailing around us. Along with adrenaline, it increases endorphins & serotonin which in particular help the brain to work more efficiently during challenging circumstances.



Fear, if utilized to its fullest potential, can be a sense of empowerment that pushes us to do better even at times we least expect. Fear is like polishing a stone. The more we polish it, the more it shines. One only needs to understand the right degree of fear that should be instilled within them. This can be understood in the following way: Every time we let our fear overpower our minds, we end up making mistakes or embarrassing ourselves, this happens because the mind is being ruled over by the emotions and not the intellect. However, if only we can control the amount of fear controlling our minds, we might just end up doing wonders. If we are still in control of our mind, along with the right amount of fear and nervousness, we can exploit that feeling to motivate ourselves by focusing on the positive talk which will ultimately end up manifesting.



Fear as mentioned is a perception; perceived by none other than our minds. Hence, it purely depends upon us whether we want to be fearful or not. For as far as I can remember, we have all been told to **keep our minds in control**. Endowed with that, we will be able to achieve many great things. One such thing, is the achievement of controlling our fears, rather than them controlling us. The art of controlling one's mind has been taught to us for ages, yet we still find it next to **impossible** to overcome fear. Although, harnessing the mind is not the only method to exploit your fear for your own benefit. One of the most successful methods is through **motivation**, especially from your close ones. It helps reduce nervousness and eradicates the thought of loneliness.



Most people are afraid to do something because they think they might end up alone, without anyone understanding them. A sense of motivation, is something one finds everywhere. Considering that nowadays, we are all surrounded by a lot of people. Let me tell you about an experience which is very dear to me: Last year, our educational trip to Pune, was one of the best trips of my life. Not only did I have fun, but I also tried various adventure activities that I would usually skip. The courage that I mustered to overcome this fear of mine was all because of my friends who motivated me throughout and pushed me to cross my limits and set new boundaries. In **IMAGICA**, after a lot of persuasion from my friends, I went on a ride called '**NITRO**' (the scariest and fastest ride of the amusement park). With a heart full of anxiety, I sat on the roller coaster and held onto my friend's hand, **THE ENTIRE TIME**. Throughout, she told me that it was 'Okay', and that she was there with me.

After the ride was over, the sense of satisfaction and pride was worth so much more than the fear I used to feel before. It was that time I realized that I didn't really need to completely get rid of my fear but just learn to use it in the **right way** at the **right time** with the **right people** around me.





Sunny!

05 *Beat the Heat!*

Rishi Suresh Iyer | IB II Year, CIRS

Sunshine, flowers, beaches, pools, holidays... AH! Summer is finally here. BUT, Summer O' Summer, brings along with it a fountain of heat and a river of sweat! Our days of joy wither away, bogged down by these problems. The dreary days become longer and longer, the blissful nights become shorter and shorter and we get stuck in a spiral of tiredness.

Unfortunately, this month, is when CIRS is the most happening. CCK, 5-on-5, Basketball, Khel Mela events, Inter-house, an average student is bound to be **EXHAUSTED**. It almost seems like every second in the sun, is like a slog. **It. Is. Hard.**

Fortunate for us, we have our friendly-neighbourhood saviour from every problem. Meet Sunny! This month he brings us solutions to **BEAT THE HEAT!**

Well, summers are tough. Here are a few personal solutions to Beat the Heat!

01

COOL off from HEAD to TOE

Daunting as it sounds, a nice cold shower, should be your go to tool to refresh from the heat of summer. A cold shower **boosts your immune system**, improving overall health and metabolism. Early in the morning, late at night, cold showers are the answer to your sticky situations!

GULP your way to glory

During the summer, a water bottle is quite literally your best friend! On average, we are supposed to have anywhere between **2-4 litres a day** (that's anywhere between 10-20 glasses!) and in summer its never a harm to go as close to that number as possible.

02

03

Make some FRUITY friends

Fruits. A delicacy which are a combination of just the right amount of sweet, sour and a whole lot of **DELICIOUS**. Fruits are rich in fibre and have high water content along with many vitamins which keep the body energized during these testing times.

The BUTTERFLY Effect

Take a dip, or dive right in, a swimming pool is a blissful experience in the summer. Just a few minutes in the cool blue warrant a sure-shot solution to feeling cool and relaxed in the scorching heat. Just wait until the sun goes down and **run down to the pool for a chill-pill.**

04

05

The NATURAL Remedy

Thinking out of the box isn't enough, its time to move out of the box! It's time for a stroll in the **green, green, grass**. Stepping outside for some time in the day is quite an efficient method to cool off! Take a walk, go for a hike, do anything just get going!



If nothing works,
just grab a popsicle
and enjoy your
summers!



How Pollution Affects the Oceans

Ramkrishna Ajay Kulkarni | Grade 11 MGMT, CIRS

Do you remember the 2003 animated film 'Finding Nemo'? The story about the clownfish, Marlin, who set off on a quest through the deep blue sea in search of his son? That film grossed a total of \$871 million worldwide, and is undoubtedly among the most popular animated films ever.

Now imagine if instead of a clownfish, the same film starred Bob - a cockroach - looking for his long lost cockroach son. Not so cute now, is it? In fact, given the negative perception regarding cockroaches, this film might not have been as huge a success as 'Finding Nemo'.

But this essay is not a speculation upon the success of a 'Finding Bob's son' movie; nor does it tell you how good the original film was. The purpose of this essay is to find out why a 'Finding Nemo' of the future does not feature everyone's favorite fish. More importantly, to find out where everyone's favorite fish might have gone.

The ocean is a big place - about 1335 quintillion liters of water in total. All that water has the capacity to swallow man's creations into its depths and that is exactly what has happened over the centuries. Storms and hurricanes have sent countless cultures and civilizations of man to a watery abyss.

However, in today's world, nature is subversive to man's mastery. Man freely traverses, and exploits the oceans with no fear of repercussion. This has effectively turned the seas into humanity's collective dustbins, with every single piece of trash eventually finding its way into the oceans. It is estimated that over 5.25 trillion pieces of plastic currently pollute our oceans, with a further 8.3 million tons added every year.

But surely, our favorite fish has not been affected by this. Even though all this plastic affects marine life, someplace in the vast ocean must be safe, right? Wouldn't our favorite fish have survived somehow? After all, he did survive long swims, hungry sharks and blundering whales while searching for his son.

But this where we humans err, because when pollution is the killer, no place is safe. By simply assuming that fishes will remain safe by swimming away to another home in the vast sea, we are effectively saying that civilians displaced by war can happily walk into another country and continue their life. The impact of pollution on our oceans is extremely detrimental and its consequences are far reaching. In fact, at least 1,00,000 aquatic organisms die due to the abundance of plastic every year. By killing the ocean and its inhabitants, we are throwing the entire ecosystem off-balance. Thereby, killing ourselves too.

So, we have found out where our favorite fish has gone - into the afterlife. The plastic that we have released into the oceans has killed him. He is lying, slowly decomposing, on the ocean bed. His intestines are clogged with plastic, and his delicate body is shrouded in it. That is why in the future, we may rather watch the box office flop: "Finding Bob's son."



07

GOD IS JUST A CALL AWAY



Relaxing on the couch, eating at the dinner table, taking a stroll through a park and nowadays, even taking a dump in the morning; something which accompanies a modern man throughout all these and many more events in life is the humble mobile phone. A device so common in our daily lives, it can offer surprisingly profound insights into our spiritual journeys. Through this article, we explore a few parallels between a Mobile's functions and the spiritual concepts which enrich our lives, providing a unique perspective on our pursuit of growth.

The Body and the Mind

The mobile phone can be seen as the physical body, our first contact with the outside world, the instrument through which we experience the world. Our senses, like the phone's camera, the microphone and touch-pad take in information. Stored memories can be seen like the gazillion pictures and videos which we are so fond of.

Prana - the Vital Energy

The mobile phone's battery symbolizes prana - the life force that energizes our being. Just as a low battery disrupts phone calls, insufficient prana hinders our mental clarity and well-being. To maintain optimal energy, we need a holistic diet that nourishes not just the body, but also the mind and spirit. Every device is prone to heating up and becoming obsolete with overuse. However, there are also devices like our old Nokias which function smoothly even today thanks to our healthy maintenance.

Challenges as Incoming Calls

Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda ji says that problems are inevitable. They are the "free calls" which are provided by the service. We can choose to approach them head-on (answer the call), avoid them temporarily (ignore the call), or get stuck overthinking them (put the call on hold). Every challenge offers an opportunity for growth, and missing it is like a missed call... it may come ringing back later!

The True Home Within...

When we are centered and at peace, in our "OM" state, we experience a sense of inner harmony, similar to being in our home network or 'closed caller group' where calls are free. However, when we get caught up in the external world (roaming), everything becomes a tad bit more taxing. Our life becomes harmonious when we are rooted within our true 'Home' - 'OM'!

The Uniqueness of the Self

While mobile phones may appear similar, each one has a unique identity. Just like each individual possesses a distinct sense of self. The SIM card, representing the senses, intellect, and mind, can be transferred into another device, much like when our essence carries over after death to another body. Our karmic record, like the balance on a SIM card, remains with us across numerous lifetimes, as we don newer and newer bodies. Your first mobile might be a basic button phone and your next one a One Plus 15, the SIM remains the same - just like how across various unique and different bodies, the self remains the same.

The Myth of Multi-tasking

Just as constant multi-tasking drains a phone's battery, research shows it reduces our efficiency too. Similarly, focusing on too many things at once depletes our energy. True effectiveness lies in mindful action, like using a phone for a specific purpose and then simply putting it down.

The Network Divine

The mobile phone company that connects all users can be seen as a metaphor for the Divine. We are all interconnected through a universal force - Ishwara. The electricity that powers individual phones represents the Atman - the individual Self - while the electricity powering the entire network signifies Brahman, the universal Self. Both are ultimately one, as expressed in the spiritual principle 'Tat Tvam Asi' - 'That thou art.'

Karma and Consequences

The way we use our phones reflects our karma, and the consequences manifest in the form of a "bill" - the results of our actions. Unresolved karma accumulates until the time is ripe for us to experience its effects.

Letting Go and Finding Peace

Many people struggle to disconnect from their phones, just as we often find it difficult to detach from the pleasures of the physical world. A person of wisdom, uses the phone when needed, but can also switch it off without anxiety. They are not dependent on external stimuli for peace and security. They experience and enjoy the physical world when required and are completely in control on how to cut off even at a moment's thought.

This exploration of the parallels between mobile phones and spirituality offers a fresh way to contemplate our inner journeys. Understanding these connections helps us leverage this everyday tool to find deeper meaning and navigate life's challenges with greater awareness.

Why don't you take up this exercise? Just like learning Leadership lessons from a Tea Bag or Emotional Intelligence from a movie on dogs, why don't you come up with your own analogy to learn something amazing?

THROUGH HIS LENS

Sri. BG Sripal - HOD | Dept. of Languages

SIR, YOUR LOVE AND COMMAND OVER THE HINDI LANGUAGE IS WELL KNOWN TO ALL OF US. WHAT INSPIRED YOU TO BECOME A HINDI TEACHER AT THE SCHOOL LEVEL?

It was my college professor, Sri. Satish Kapoor, who inspired me to be the teacher I am today. He was as fluent in Sanskrit as he was in Hindi and this made him the most sought after teacher in college. When I used to attend his lectures, I saw a part of me that wanted to follow this path.

WE HAVE OBSERVED VERY WELL THAT THE STUDENT COMMUNITY IS VERY CLOSE TO YOU. BEING ONE OF THE SENIOR TEACHERS, HOW LONG HAVE YOU BEEN A PART OF THE CIRS FAMILY?

I joined CIRS in the year 2012, and the batch of students that I am teaching currently is my 13th batch. In fact, it is quite a story that I am teaching here, as I had appeared for 50 interviews simultaneously, and I would later go on to choose this school.

TALKING ABOUT YOUR HOSTEL DAYS AS A STUDENT, COULD YOU SHARE AN INCIDENT WITH US THAT IS FOREVER ETCHED IN YOUR MEMORY?

In my hostel days, cricket was a sport that was many loved. So I once thought, why not just swing the bat and play some cricket? However, it turned out to be quite eventful. As I was batting, I swung the bat so hard that it loosened from the handle. This resulted in the bat splitting into 2 pieces. The handle of which was still in my hand, but unfortunately, the rest of the bat flew and hit a friend of mine. It surely was a day that I would never forget!

MANY OF US HAVE HEARD STORIES ABOUT YOUR ARM-WRESTLING SKILLS. ARE THESE JUST RUMOURS OR IS IT A TRUE STORY?

(Laughs) I was once sleeping on the rooftop in my college, and I heard some Bhaiyas (who served in my college) downstairs. When I peeked down, I saw that they were arm-wrestling and I saw one of them being crowned as the champion. This was the start on my spree to defeat all the other competitors. Finally, came the day that I defeated the previous winner and it was me who was crowned the champion. The wrestling part is not that prominent though. (Laughs)

08



AS AN EXPERIENCED TEACHER, WHAT IS AN INTERESTING ANECDOTE YOU WOULD LIKE TO SHARE WITH US?

For practice, I used to give my students worksheets and it always happened that it exceeded a page. One day, a girl from the 12th grade asked me to try making the font smaller and print the text on both sides, so that less paper would get wasted. This may seem as a very small thing, however to me, it was very impressive since it was not coming from an adult but a 12th grade girl! This is an incident I can never forget, as it showed the beauty of the value systems of the school.

WE HAVE HEARD THAT YOU ARE A MAN OF MANY PASSIONS. IF WE WERE TO ASK, COULD YOU LIST YOUR PASSIONS, OF COURSE, EXCEPT TEACHING?

Oh, I do have a lot of passions. Starting from repairing computer hardware to video editing. I once even earned ₹ 1 Lakh in 3 days for my work in sound editing. I love farming and I equally share a passion for seva and pravachan too. A tad bit more about me, I gave my application for the Indian Army. I passed the exam and was selected in it too!

THANK YOU
FOR EVERYTHING!

INFLUENCE OF WORDS

Jai - an everyday school kid - was an eleven year-old boy who had just completed his English term exam quite well. He was in a very good mood and had gone to the badminton court to play as usual. Everything was going well for him. He had just won a streak of matches and was set to play against his next contender. His recent wins added to his upbeat mood, setting the stage for what should have been another victorious match, but this time when the opponent was in a disadvantageous situation, he snapped and started insulting Jai. Jai was teased, and fat-shamed. This infuriated him, making the anger cloud his thinking. He began losing points, eventually losing the match, ruining the entire day for him too.

Now we have Arjun, a promising football player who had lost last year's football tournament, but had greater hopes for this one as he had practiced all year long. This time was going to be his last as he was about to graduate. He was also the captain of his team. His excitement peaked as the whistle blew and the match began with the opponent's kick-off. They perfectly maneuvered through the first line, with the ball-handler now directly in front of Arjun. Arjun became very nervous. The opponent stared directly into his eyes; Arjun froze. The competitor had gotten past him as well and scored the first goal. The team collapsed, their captain who had been practicing day and night, froze when the opponent was right in front of him.

The coach used his first timeout; he called Arjun aside separately and whispered in his ear, "You have amazing potential, certainly more than anyone in the team. The entire team believes in you, and that is why I put you as captain. If you get scared and lose hope, our team is going to crumble. So, stay focused. Try to think about attacking them in an offbeat manner. They will never expect it. Inspire your teammates. Now go out there and give your best!" Arjun didn't speak a word and rushed to the center of the field. His dithering teammates started the kick-off, and passed the ball to Arjun. Arjun rushed using his right, dribbled and shifted the ball to his left, hit a nutmeg and whacked a screamer into the top right corner. He didn't stop there though; he completed his hat-trick and slid into the goal post. The whole team came and fell on him overjoyed by his performance.

Through both the examples above, we see that the influence of words is immense, affecting our emotions and actions significantly. Whether they lift us up or bring us down, words hold the power to shape our experiences and results. It's crucial to be mindful of the words we use and how they impact others, as they can have a long lasting effect on individuals and situations. Being mindful of our words may make a significant impact in how others feel and how things turn out.



CIRS is a place unlike any other. Throughout the last month, we have had countless events organised and enthused. The Crossroads Editorial Team brings you a report, featuring a few of these events which took place recently.

HOLI

"Holi as usual in CIRS, has been a mind-blowing experience. Even though the story has been running for years, this year's presentation was different and extraordinary. Moreover, the experience of playing Holi with my friends has never failed to give me joy. It was a great experience to cap off my journey at CIRS!"

- Gaurav V. Ranjan | IB Final Year, CIRS



RAMA NAVAMI

"When I was told that I would be acting as Bhagwan Shri Ram, I was curious to know more about the life of Shri Ram. Initially, I thought that I just had to be graceful in whatever I was doing, and the acting would be done. As the practice began, I realized that it is not as easy as I thought. I understood that I had to live the role and only then will I truly be able to act well. As the practice continued, I felt that the role became more natural. I was able to be graceful without any effort. This effect was not only visible in the acting, but also in my daily life. I started to enjoy every moment and it felt so special. I understood how a person should live one's life. I understood that one should never compromise when it comes to doing the right thing. I am extremely honored to have been able to act as Bhagwan Shri Ram.

JAI SHRI RAM!"

- Rohith CB | Grade 11, CIRS



CCK

"More than a journey in cricket, it was a journey we made as friends. The last month brought all of us so much closer together. The early morning practices, the late night team meetings, all we did for the past few weeks was live and breathe cricket. Though we didn't finish how we expected, the experience at the end of our 4th year in CCK was enriching to say the least!"

- Minions In Black | Grade 12 Team, CCK 2024



11

GAIA'S SPELL - A BIHAR STORY

Aashi Kedia | Grade 9, CIRS

The tale of Bihar delivered a timeless bond - a shared history where humans recognized the significance of harmonizing with nature.

In the heart of Bihar, a dance of symbolism unfolded between Nature and Man. The mystical terrain narrated a tale of unity, where farmers nurtured the earth with age-old wisdom, handed down through the ages. Above, as Indra's tears revitalized the arid fields, orchestrating a dance of existence between the denizens and the divine downpour. Rivers, the veins of Bihar's essence, bestowed seasonal blessings upon the soil. In harmony with the rhythms of nature. Villagers revered Mother Ganga not just as a mere river, but as a fountain of spiritual solace. The forests sang the ballads of ancient biodiversity, where flora and fauna danced to the tunes of abundance and nourishment. Amongst the verdant canopy, villagers sought healing herbs, honoring nature as their nourishing mother - an eternal healer. Yet, amidst this tale of treasures untold, the blight of human interference rose its ugly hood. Urbanization marred the rural idyll, disrupting the delicate equilibrium. The chronicles of Bihar narrated a timeless tale—a shared legacy, where mortals acknowledged the essence of aligning with nature, recognizing their fates entwined with the pulsating heartbeat of the land they called 'home'.





NATURE'S EMBRACE

AN ODE TO THE MOTHER

MALINI KHEMLANI | 18 | YEAR, CIRS



Amidst the trials and tribulations of daily life, it's easy to overlook the weighty influence of our mothers in our life. While we cherish various relationships, the role of our mother often remains underappreciated. Mother's Day, a celebration initiated by Anna Jarvis in 1907, serves as a reminder of the selfless love and sacrifices of mothers worldwide. Beyond biological ties, this day also recognizes the nurturing essence of mother nature, which sustains and augments all our lives in various ways.

Mothers exemplify strength, resilience, and unconditional love. They navigate physical and emotional challenges to ensure our well-being and prepare us for life's journey. Like a rock in unbridled waters, a mother's love is unwavering and endless. From wholesome nurturers to fierce protectors, mothers shape our character. They are the very heartbeat of our homes, yet do we truly express gratitude for their lifelong commitment to our upbringing?

Anna Jarvis's tribute to her mother's legacy catalyzed the establishment of Mother's Day as an international holiday. The day honors all mothers, and even goes so far to extend appreciation to the nurturing force of mother nature. Just as Anna's mother fostered friendship and health among women, Mother's Day celebrates the profound impact of maternal figures in shaping society.

Now comes the catch, from the days of yore, we have witnessed Kausalya's pride and jumped with joy, when we heard about Yashoda's chide. Motherhood seems to embrace every child. Be it Duryodhana so wild, or Yudhishtira so kind.

However, motherhood as a quality does not seem to just be the forte of human beings. Mothers can be found in every nook and cranny of the world. Calves at the udder's caress, fledglings within their tranquil nest, cubs enclosed within their cozy zest.

This also makes one wonder at times, is it only a mother's care or also a father's concern? What about a sister's comfort? A grandparent's caution? This search gave our ancients perhaps one of their wildest personifications. They personified nature itself as a symbol of motherhood.

Mother Nature transcends mere sustenance, offering beauty, joy, and solace. From breathtaking sunsets to the gentle sway of trees, nature enriches our lives and fosters connections. This bond extends beyond humans, evident in the nurturing instincts of animals. Whether teaching young birds to fly or guiding polar bear cubs through icy landscapes, her maternal care echoes throughout the natural world.

As stewards of the earth, it's our responsibility to reciprocate nature's boundless generosity. By reducing our carbon footprint, embracing renewable energy, and supporting sustainable practices, we can safeguard our planet for future generations.

Every small effort; from minimizing single-use plastics, to advocating for eco-friendly initiatives, contributes to a greener, more sustainable world.

Mothers are a symbol of love and nurture, perhaps they are also synonymous with nature itself. Just as a mother's love shapes a child's development, the natural world provides the foundation for our growth. Our surroundings, experiences, and the nurturing presence of mothers and mother nature alike, influence our journey of blossoming and self-discovery.

Beyond mere acknowledgment, celebrating Mother's Day also serves as a poignant reminder of familial unity and most importantly an expression of gratitude to nature. Recognizing the tireless efforts of mothers fosters stronger family bonds, reinforces the interconnectedness of humanity, and affirms our oneness with nature. By honoring mothers and Mother Nature alike, we affirm our commitment to cherishing and preserving the nurturing forces that sustain us.

As we celebrate Mother's Day, let us not only honor the women who shape our lives, but also pay homage to the bountiful gifts of Mother Nature. In nurturing and protecting both, we ensure a harmonious existence for generations to come. Just as mothers are the glue that binds families, the celebration of Mother's Day unites us in gratitude and appreciation for the nurturing forces that enrich our lives.



ABC OF THE STOCK MARKET



**YOU ARE NOW
CAPABLE OF
BEING A WARRIOR
IN THE STOCK
MARKET!**



Whenever you strike up a financial discussion, you are bound to come across mind-boggling terms like: Nifty – 50, Sensex and Mutual Funds. However, what are these terms in reality? Simply put, Nifty-50 and Sensex are the benchmark index values to measure the performance of the most important financial transaction network in the world – The Stock Market.

‘Benchmark index values’ means they are a means to check the performance of a certain set of stocks in the market. Let’s take an example: Assume Nifty – 50 goes up. This means the average price of all stocks goes up as well. Take the benchmark to be a value of ‘X’. ‘X’ contains the top 50 companies in the oil sector. Within those 50 companies, the share price of 15 companies go up, while 5 companies go down. Thus, the overall price of ‘X’ goes up. Further, the average performance of the market is also measured by averages of these same values.

Benchmarks like these are not measured in currency, but rather in points. This is because you cannot exactly buy these values. They are only and only used in order to measure the performance of sets of stocks. If a lot of these indexes are purchased, the overall performance of the share market is good. These values are created by different stock exchanges from all over the world. Nifty – 50 is made by the National Stock Exchange while Sensex is made by the Bombay Stock Exchange.

On the other side of the spectrum, contrary to the hard-work and grind of the stock market, mutual funds are something where someone else does the work for you and picks stocks for you. In exchange, they take a commission out of your returns. They usually maintain positive returns and rarely incur losses. People usually choose mutual funds with higher returns than the average market performance.

Next time you see Sachin in a Mutual Funds ad, you will never be confused! Armed with this knowledge, the next time you look at the paper and see rise and falls in the values of Sensex and other benchmarks, remember that you are now capable of being a warrior in the stock market who fends for themselves in the real world!



– Naitik Agarwala

PAPYRUS

Anirudh P. | Grade 7, CIRS



Paper is a material special for all,
It comes from trees which are pretty tall,
Paper is much more important than you think,
As this poem was written on it with this ink.

Oh, my wonderful paper,
You can't make me any happier,
I thank you for helping me to write,
And making this poem a great delight!

Paper has many interesting uses,
Such as writing letters with excuses,
It can be used to make aeroplanes,
And some have a habit of eating it plain.

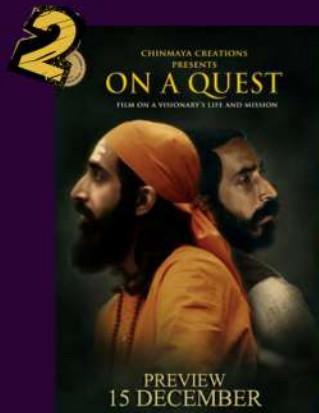


Crossbusters

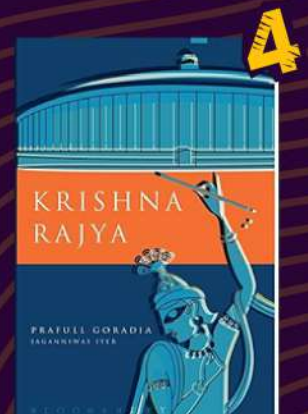
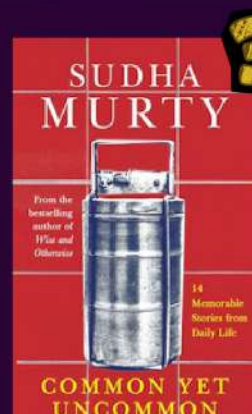
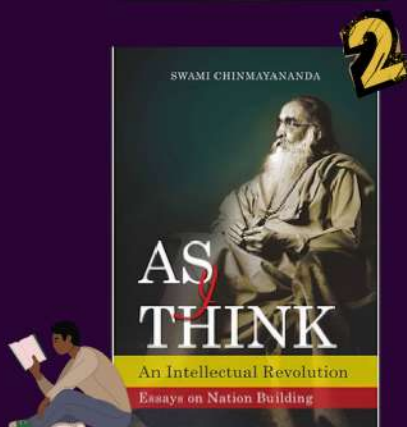
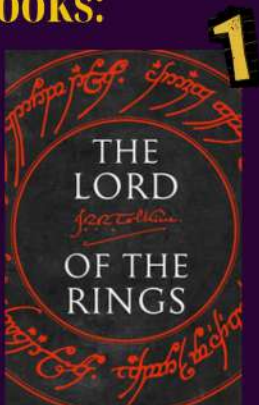


The long-awaited vacations are just around the corner! Here are a few scintillating picks for you to stay engrossed during the break

Movies & Shows:



Books:



Captures







CREATIVE CORNER



Siddhant Jain ~ VIII 🙏



Devesh Kumar ~ VII 🙏



Pirai Soodan ~ VII 🙏



Arya ~ VIII 🙏



Mokshita G. ~ X 🙏



Shri. Atul Pawar Ji (Department of Fine Arts) 🙏



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You are successful and creative only when you see an opportunity in every difficulty - Swami Chinmayananda

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